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Freely-Given-org / **OpenEnglishTranslation--OET**

Code Issues 7 Pull requests Discussions Actions Projects More

OpenEnglishTranslation--OET Public

Notifications Fork 2

About

The Open English Translation (OET) of the Bible -- a unique, completely free and open-licensed new modern-English Bible translation

OpenEnglishTranslation.Bible

bible english free literal open translation

Readme

Activity Custom properties

22 stars 1 watching 2 forks

Report repository

1326fe7 Go to file Code

Robert and **Robert** — Merge branch 'main' of github.com:Freely-Given-org... — 1326fe7 · 2 days ago

derivedTexts	Fix some LV errors; tidied xrefs in the R...	3 days ago
exportedFiles	Fix some LV errors; tidied xrefs in the R...	3 days ago
intermediateTexts	Fix some LV errors; tidied xrefs in the R...	3 days ago
scripts	Fix some LV errors; tidied xrefs in the R...	3 days ago
sourceTexts	34% of OET-RV drafted	2 years ago
	Merge branch 'main' of github.com:Fre...	2 days ago

translatedTexts/ReadersVersion		
.gitignore	Updates plus some section formatting f...	5 months ago
OTNamesInNT.tsv	Updated OET-LV so BEHOLD is visible. C...	5 months ago
README.md	Removed word numbers from OET-RV a...	last month
pyproject.toml	Updated OET-LV so BEHOLD is visible. C...	5 months ago

View all files

README

OpenEnglishTranslation (OET)

The ***Open English Translation*** **of the Bible (OET)** -- a unique, exciting, completely free and open-licensed, new modern-English Bible translation

The new website is at https://OET.Bible. (The previous one was at https://Freely-Given.org/BibleTranslations/English/OET/.) The Bible text is also available at the *Open Bible Data* website at https://Freely-Given.org/OBD/.

The design features can be found under the 'Design' menu at https://OET.Bible.

Background

The *Open English Translation* project has been planned for over fifteen years (a draft of Jonah was done in 2010), although circumstances only allowed for full-time development to begin in mid-2022 after a 12+ year wait.

Introduction

Perhaps one of the main differences from existing English translations that should be mentioned here is this: All translations must choose to place themselves somewhere on the line that moves from being very literal (some people might perhaps naively think this is being accurate to the original), to being more helpful to the reader by being more free/dynamic (in making a translation that fills in some of the implied information that might have been obvious to the original readers). The *Open English Translation* handles this by choosing **two points on the literal ⇔ dynamic line**

instead of just one! The two versions (one *very* literal and one more dynamic) are intended to be used together (and never alone).

Another major difference, is that the *Open English Translation* **is freely available** for others to use and publish in Bible studies and similar materials (including research theses), to analyse, to print, to display on any device, and even to change/customise (with only small limitations) to meet other specific needs.

Many other English Bible translations claim to be 'modern' (and it's not our aim to disparage them) but it's easy to see that many phrases and terms have been carried into them all the way back from Tyndale (1500's) and even from Wycliffe (1300's). For example, the *Open English Translation* doesn't start sentences with the conjunction 'For' as we don't hear that in modern speech. (By the way, the 'For' in the previous sentence is a preposition, not a conjunction.) There's also much less use of 'of' to indicate possession (e.g., 'house of Peter') as we tend to use apostrophe ('s) in modern English (e.g., Peter's house). Plus we try to remove as much 'Christianese' as possible.

After several years of waiting, the *Open English Translation* project was restarted in the second half of 2022 (as soon as the new Statistical Restoration Greek New Testament dataset was officially released by the Center for New Testament Restoration). This work started with a review of our design and work on new planned file formats, and then a focus on creating the New Testament portion of the Literal Version. Are you interested in helping or supporting this effort? If so, please use our Contact Page or here.

The Old Testament portion is be based on the work of the Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible team (although we prefer to call it 'The Hebrew Scriptures' rather than 'The Old Testament' and we call 'The New Testament' 'The Messianic Update'.)

Some frequently asked questions (FAQs) about the OET can be found here.

The *Open English Translation* will eventually be available in six versions:

- Literal Version (also see the original blog announcement) which may then be printed/displayed alongside one of the:
- Readers' Version (also see the original blog announcement), the
- Colloquial Version, the
- Study Version (also see the original blog announcement), or the
- Extended Version (also see the original blog announcement), and possibly the
- *Digest Version* for those who want the essence without some of the trivia (like Paul forgetting his coat in Troas).

If you're a professional Bible translator or consultant or notes-writer, or if you're an app developer and able to help us in this endeavour, please start a conversation with us via our Contact Page.

Schedule

As of August 2026, the entire Bible has been drafted. (This status page is kept updated with our progress.) Our goal is to complete v0.5 by the end of 2027, but we need more eyes on the text.

Licences

Our *OET* Bible text is licensed CC BY-SA 4.0 (Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International).

Any included scripts are licensed GPL 3.0 or later.

The inevitable event

It is my request to my family and executors of my will to place all of this work into the public domain, finished or unfinished, on the event of my death. It has always been my desire that the *Open English Translation* be a gift to the world, including the *Literal Version*, the *Readers' Version*, and any other versions made under my control or under the auspices of Freely-Given.org.

Please note that any contributions by others to this project will only be accepted on these same grounds.

Releases

No releases published

Contributors 3


RobH123 Robert


ChrisCDes


tmakarios

Languages



- **Python** 98.9%
- **Makefile** 1.1%